overtures, the government and the Fazlullah-led militants reached a 16-point agreement on 21 May 2008 to end violence and restore peace in Swat. Within days of signing the agreement, the militants reneged on the terms of peace deal by demanding more concessions from the government like withdrawing troops from Swat first and release of Taliban prisoners. Within a month, the militants started targeting government officials and installations. Finally, Operation 'Rah-e-Haq' was launched (*Dawn*, 2008). More violence followed in the aftermath of the operation as schools were torched, police station and army convoys were attacked and civilians were kidnapped and beheaded. The violence ended after the implementation of *Sharia*-based Nizam-e-Adl regulation in Swat on 15 February 2009.

This forced Fazlullah in declaring a ceasefire (Khattak, 2009).

NIZAM-E-ADL PEACE DEAL IN SWAT (2009)

The latest peace deal between the NWFP (now Khyber Pakhtunkhwa) government led by the secular ANP and TNSM in Swat was signed on 16 February 2009. However, it was also breached due to the following two main reasons: first, the government had failed to learn from the previous peace deals experience that the nature of dispute and the form of the militants was quite different from the traditional tribal disputes between clans, tribes or individuals or even an invading force that could be resolved through *Roogha* and *Soolah*.

Secondly, ironically, Sufi Muhammad, a party to the issue, posed to be the mediator between the NWFP (KP) government and the TTP leader Maulvi Fazlullah and signed the deal. Many, within Pakistan and especially in the West, considered it a surrender of Swat Valley to the militants after a bloody two-year battle (*The Nation*, 2009).

In pursuance of the peace deal, the *Nizam-e-Adl* (the justice system) Regulation 2009 was passed by the National Assembly of Pakistan by unanimous resolution, after a debate of less than 30 minutes, on 14 April 2009. Only the MQM abstained. On the next day, the governor NWFP (KP) promulgated the regulation. It sparked criticism at home and abroad (*The Nation*, 2009).

Even after the signing of the peace deal and imposition of Nizam-e-Adl, devastating suicide attacks were carried out in Dera Ismail Khan, Lahore, Peshawar, Rawalpindi, Jamrud, Charsadda and so on